2016 Hyundai Veloster

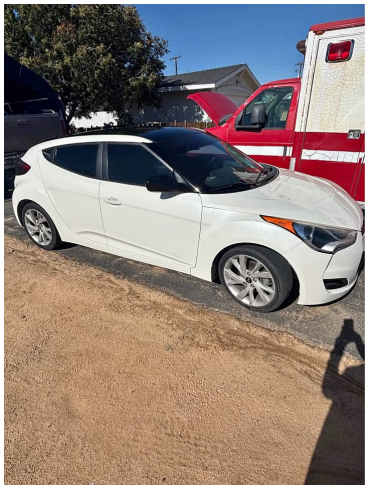
$3,500 · 160,000 miles · Private seller · California City, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/1116471874471400/

Report generated October 29, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder



Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$4,002	**$393**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 1 recalls · 225 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$3,500.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$323.75
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$22.75
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$32.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$4,001.50
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$4,001.50
Amount financed	$0.00
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$4,151.50

Paid in full with your down payment — no loan needed.

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$0.00
Insurance (estimate, liability)	$70.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 30 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$158.33
Maintenance & repair reserve	$150.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$14.40
Total per month	$392.73

Running costs without the loan: **$393/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$8,864** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **liability coverage** estimate ($70/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

The 2012-17 Veloster's 1.6L is average; the optional dual-clutch automatic can be jerky and costly to fix. Ask which transmission it has.

NHTSA data for this model year: 1 recalls · 225 owner complaints (15 involving a crash). Most complaints: Engine (134), Power Train (43), Unknown Or Other (32), Fuel/Propulsion System (20), Electrical System (16), Air Bags (11).

Known issues for this model

• Dual-clutch (EcoShift) transmission problems if equipped

• Carbon buildup on the direct-injected 1.6L

• Hatch/door rattles

• Clutch wear on manuals

Check on this car before buying

• Title status and name

- Which transmission (6-speed auto, dual-clutch, or manual)
- No check-engine light; scan for codes
- A/C cold

Notes

IN-TOWN CAR (~$3k, for getting to and from work in Ridgecrest; not a DoorDash pick).

$3,500, ~160k mi. 'Runs good, everything works, A/C blows cold.' Listed 2026-10-28. TITLE NOT STATED - ask if it's clean and in the seller's name before going.

Newest of the in-town options; ~30 MPG. ~25 min from Ridgecrest.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.